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Freeform metrology information acquisition system

Abstract

A freeform metrology information acquisition system is disclosed. The system includes a measurement probe, one or more cameras, and a computing device. The measurement probe is configured to obtain metrology information for an object under inspection. The camera(s) are configured to image a scene including the measurement probe and the object under inspection. The computing device is configured to receive the metrology information from the measurement probe, receive one or more images from the one or more cameras, determine a position of the measurement probe in the scene based at least on the one or more images, spatially registering the metrology information acquired by the measurement probe to one or more determined positions of the measurement probe in the scene, and visually present, via a display, a visual representation of the metrology information spatially registered to the one or more determined positions of the measurement probe in the scene.

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FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims priority to U.S. Patent Application Ser. No. 63/324,535, filed Mar. 28, 2022, the entirety of which is hereby incorporated herein by reference for all purposes.

BACKGROUND

(1) Metrology information provides standard units of measurement that are used to describe physical characteristics of an object. For example, metrology information for an object under inspection can be acquired to assess a state or quality of the object. In particular, the metrology information for the object can be compared to specified thresholds or requirements to determine whether conformity is achieved for different physical characteristics of the object under inspection. Traditional methods of metrology information acquisition rely on devices that have complex assemblies that are configured to acquire metrology information for specific objects under inspection. These devices have very limited use in very specific scenarios.

SUMMARY

(2) A freeform metrology information acquisition system is disclosed. The system includes a measurement probe, one or more cameras, and a computing device. The measurement probe is configured to obtain metrology information for an object under inspection. The one or more cameras are configured to image a scene including the measurement probe and the object under inspection. The computing device is communicatively coupled to the measurement probe and the one or more cameras. The computing device is configured to receive the metrology information from the measurement probe, receive one or more images from the one or more cameras, determine a position of the measurement probe in the scene based at least on the one or more images, spatially registering the metrology information acquired by the measurement probe to one or more determined positions of the measurement probe in the scene, and visually present, via a display, a

visual representation of the metrology information spatially registered to the one or more determined positions of the measurement probe in the scene.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 shows an embodiment of a freeform metrology information acquisition system **100** according to the present disclosure.
- (2) FIG. 2 shows a schematic view of the freeform metrology acquisition system shown in FIG. 1.
- (3) FIG. 3 shows a schematic view of a measurement probe of the freeform metrology information acquisition system shown in FIG. 1.
- (4) FIG. 4 shows an example visual representation of metrology information spatially registered to an object under inspection.
- (5) FIG. 5 shows an example 3D model of an object under inspection textured with metrology information spatially registered to corresponding regions of the object under inspection.
- (6) FIG. 6 shows an example visual representation of a motion path of a measurement probe as the measurement probe scans an object under inspection.
- (7) FIG. 7 is a flowchart of an example computer-implemented freeform metrology information acquisition method.
- (8) FIG. 8 schematically shows an example computing system environment in which the computing device of FIG. 1 may be implemented.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (9) Traditional methods of metrology information acquisition rely on devices that have complex assemblies that are configured to acquire metrology information for specific objects under inspection. In one example, traditional ultrasound inspection relies upon devices that include a complex assembly of encoders, linear bearings, shafts, etc. to keep track of the position of an ultrasonic transducer in three-dimensional (3D) space during ultrasonic inspection of an object. A traditional ultrasound inspection device has to be physically attached to an object in order to perform ultrasonic inspection of the object. In one example, a traditional ultrasonic inspection device is specifically configured to be physically attached to a pipe to perform ultrasonic inspection of the pipe. In another example, a traditional ultrasonic inspection device is specifically configured to be physically attached to a flat surface, such as a carbon fiber panel, to inspect the carbon fiber panel. In these examples, the traditional ultrasonic inspection devices are configured for specific applications (e.g., pipes, flat surfaces) and do not have the flexibility to perform ultrasound inspection on other types of objects having different shapes or different types of surfaces.
- (10) However, in many cases, it is not possible to attach these types of traditional ultrasonic inspection devices to objects other than the certain types of objects for which they are specifically designed. For example, the surface of an object may be non-magnetic, slippery, hot/cold, or may have other characteristics that impede physical attachment of a traditional ultrasonic inspection device to the object.
- (11) Furthermore, there is increasing demand for composite structures that are organically shaped and curved to be inspected using ultrasound-based techniques. Most inspection surfaces of such composite structures are not standard shapes, such as pipe or a flat surface. Traditional ultrasonic inspection devices are rigid and non-flexible which do not permit accurate surface measurements of composite structures (or other objects made of different materials) having organic shapes and curves. Moreover, traditional ultrasonic inspection devices are only two-dimensional. Currently, there is no method of capturing three-dimensional position data for industrial ultrasound measurement systems. Note that the issues present in traditional ultrasonic inspection devices also apply to other types of traditional metrology information acquisition devices.

(12) Accordingly, the present description is directed to a freeform metrology information acquisition system. The system comprises a measurement probe configured to obtain metrology information for an object under inspection. The system further comprises one or more cameras configured to image a scene including the measurement probe and the object under inspection. The system further comprises a computing device configured to determine a position of the measurement probe in the scene, spatially register the metrology information acquired by the measurement probe to one or more determined positions of the measurement probe in the scene, and visually present a visual representation of the metrology information spatially registered to the one or more determined positions of the measurement probe in the scene via a display.

(13) The freeform metrology information acquisition system leverages machine vision to enable a universal coordinate system to be used to spatially register metrology information to an object under inspection. Such spatial registration of the metrology information to the object under inspection provides the technical benefit of offering visual feedback that allows for a state or quality of the object under inspection to be more easily assessed relative to other metrology information acquisition systems. Moreover, the freeform metrology information acquisition system can be used on any number of different objects having complex, extensive, and/or non-standard surfaces. In contrast, traditional metrology information acquisition systems would be unable to accurately acquire metrology information for these types of objects.

(14) FIG. 1 shows an embodiment of a freeform metrology information acquisition system **100** according to the present disclosure. The system **100** comprises a plurality of cameras **102** (e.g., **102A**, **102B**, and **102C**) that have fixed positions with respect to one another and with respect to a scene **104**. In the illustrated embodiment, the plurality of cameras are coupled to a rigid frame **106** that maintains the fixed positions and fixed orientations of the plurality of cameras **102**. Each of the plurality of cameras **102** capture a different vantage point of a capture volume **108** in the scene **104**. The capture volume **108** is defined as a 3D space captured by the collective fields of view of the plurality of cameras **102**. The plurality of cameras **102** are calibrated to have a common coordinate system that is applied to the capture volume **108** as well as objects in the capture volume **108**.

(15) The system **100** comprises a computing device communicatively coupled to each of the plurality of cameras **102**. The computing device **110** is configured to control operation of the plurality of cameras **102** to capture images of the capture volume **108** (including objects positioned therewithin). For example, the computing device **110** can control the plurality of cameras **102** to capture temporally synchronized images (or video streams including sequences of images) of the capture volume **108**. The captured images are sent from the plurality of cameras **102** to the computing device **110** for computer processing.

(16) An object **112** is positioned in the capture volume **108**. The object **112** is referred to herein as the object under inspection because the system **100** acquires metrology information for the object. In the illustrated example, the object under inspection takes the form of a bicycle frame **112** having an organic and curved shape that would be difficult for a traditional ultrasonic inspection device to inspect. The computing device **110** is configured to determine a position and an orientation of the bicycle frame **112** in the common coordinate system of the plurality of cameras **102** based on images captured by the plurality of cameras **102**.

(17) In some examples, a plurality of fiducial markers (not shown) are placed at different positions on the bicycle frame **112**, and the computing device **110** is configured to determine the position and/or orientation of the bicycle frame **112** based at least on the position of the fiducial markers. In other examples, the computing device **110** is configured to recognize various features (e.g., edges, curves) of the bicycle frame **112** and determine the position and/or orientation of the bicycle frame **112** based at least on such features. In some examples, different regions of the bicycle frame **112** are mapped to different coordinates of the common coordinate system of the plurality of cameras **102**. The computing device **110** can determine the position and/or orientation of the bicycle frame **112** in any suitable manner.

- (18) The system **100** comprises a measurement probe **114** configured to acquire metrology information for an object under inspection. The measurement probe **114** is communicatively coupled with the computing device **110**. The measurement probe **114** is configured to send the acquired metrology information to the computing device **110** for computer processing.
- (19) In the illustrated example, the measurement probe **114** includes an ultrasonic transducer that is configured to acquire subsurface information for an object under inspection. The measurement probe **114** is held by a human subject—i.e., an inspector **116**. The inspector **116** moves the measurement probe **114** along the bicycle frame **112** to scan various parts of the bicycle frame **112** to acquire subsurface information via the ultrasonic transducer. The subsurface information characterizes a structural state of the various parts of the bicycle frame **112**. For example, the subsurface information can be used to identify defects, other forms of degradation, or other structural characteristics in the bicycle frame **112**.
- (20) The measurement probe **114** is referred to herein as being freeform, because the measurement probe **114** can be moved freely throughout the capture volume **108** to acquire metrology information for various parts or regions of interest of the bicycle frame **112** (or another object under inspection). The freeform nature of the measurement probe **114** means that the measurement probe **114** is not required to be attached to an object under inspection in order to acquire metrology information for the object under inspection. This allows the inspector **116** to quickly and flexibly scan any desired part or region of interest of the bicycle frame **112** to acquire subsurface information via the ultrasonic transducer for that desired part or region of interest.
- (21) Movement of the measurement probe **114** is tracked by the computing device **110**. To that end, the measurement probe **114** includes a plurality of fiducial markers **118** having positions fixed relative to one another. The plurality of fiducial markers **118** form a fixed pattern, referred to as a rigid object, that is a non-deformable structure whose orientation and position can be tracked by the computing device **110**. In the illustrated example, the measurement probe **114** includes four fiducial markers that enable the computing device to determine the position and orientation of the measurement probe **114**.
- (22) The computing device **110** is configured to determine the position and orientation of the measurement probe **114** in the scene **104** based at least on the positions of the plurality of fiducial markers **118** in the images captured by the plurality of cameras **102**. Further, the computing device **110** is configured to spatially register the metrology information acquired by the measurement probe **114** to one or more determined locations of the measurement probe **114** in the scene. In one example, the computing device **110** is configured to determine a position of the measurement probe **114** when the measurement probe **114** acquires subsurface information via the ultrasonic transducer. For example, such subsurface information may be augmented with metadata that includes a timestamp indicating the time at which the subsurface information is acquired. The computing device **110** is configured to match the timestamped subsurface information with corresponding images captured by the plurality of cameras **102** having the same or similar timestamps to spatially register the subsurface information to the determined location of the measurement probe **114**. In the illustrated example, the determined location corresponds to the distal end of the measurement probe **114** where the ultrasonic transducer resides.
- (23) The computing device **110** is configured to visually present, via a display **120**, a visual representation **122** of the metrology information acquired by the measurement probe **114** and spatially registered to the determined location(s) of the measurement probe in the scene **104**. In the illustrated example, the visual representation **122** of the metrology information is subsurface information represented by different patterns (e.g., a heat map) that is textured spatially registered to the location of the bicycle frame **112** in the image presented via the display **120**. In this example, as the inspector **116** scans the bicycle frame **112** with the measurement probe **114**, the subsurface information acquired by the ultrasonic transducer is presented on the display **120** in spatial alignment with the bicycle frame **112**. In some examples, the computing device **110** may generate a

composite image/video that acquires the scene image/video with the visual representation of the subsurface information spatially aligned with the bicycle frame **112**.

(24) In the illustrated example, the system **100** combines the 3D machine vision coordinate tracking system with the ultrasound subsurface information to allow for a deeper understanding of the structure of the object being inspected—e.g., the bicycle frame **112**. Further, the system **100** combines the object shape and volume information with the material thickness and ultrasound information to provide a cohesive visualization of the internal condition of the bicycle frame **112**.

(25) FIG. 2 shows a schematic view of the freeform metrology acquisition system **100** including the computing device **110**. The computing device **110** includes a processor **200** (e.g., central processing units, or “CPUs”), volatile memory **202**, non-volatile memory **204**, an input/output (I/O) module **206**, and a display **208**. The different components are operatively coupled to one another. The non-volatile memory **204** stores instructions to execute a metrology information analysis application **210**. The metrology information analysis application **210** is configured to receive one or more images **212** a scene including an object under inspection **214** and a measurement probe **114** from one or more cameras **102** (e.g., cameras **102A . . . 102N**).

(26) The camera(s) **102** may take any suitable form. In some examples, the camera(s) may include visible-light cameras (e.g., R, G, B cameras). In some examples, the camera(s) may include infrared or near-infrared cameras. In some examples, the camera(s) may include depth cameras (e.g., structured light, time-of-flight). In some examples, the camera(s) may include a combination of the different types of cameras listed above or another type of camera.

(27) The system **100** may include any suitable number of cameras **102**. In some embodiments, the system **100** may include a plurality of cameras having fixed positions relative to one another. In other embodiments, the system **100** may include a single fixed or movable camera.

(28) It will be appreciated that calibration of the camera(s) **102** may be performed in virtually any suitable manner to establish the common coordinate system. For example, various different types of calibration markers may be used to create data points for interpolation of intrinsic and extrinsic properties of the camera(s) **102**. As another example, various different calibration patterns, such as grid or checkerboard patterns, may be used to create data points for camera calibration.

(29) The metrology information analysis application **210** is configured to receive metrology information for the object under inspection **214** from the measurement probe **114**. FIG. 3 shows a schematic view of the measurement probe **114**. The measurement probe **114** includes the plurality of fiducial markers **118** that have positions that are fixed relative to one another. The metrology information analysis application **210** is configured to determine the position of the measurement probe **114** in the scene based at least on the positions of the plurality of fiducial markers **118** in the one or more images **212**. The measurement probe **114** may include any suitable number of fiducial markers **118** arranged in any suitable pattern.

(30) The plurality of fiducial markers **118** have characteristics that are conspicuous to the camera(s) **102**. In examples where the camera(s) **102** are visible light cameras (e.g., R, G, B cameras), the plurality of fiducial markers **118** may have a high-contrast color (e.g., white) that is conspicuous to the camera(s) **102**. In some examples, the fiducial markers **118** may be color-light invisible, such that the fiducial markers are not perceivable by the naked eye of a human subject. In some examples where the camera(s) **102** are IR or near-IR cameras, the plurality of fiducial markers **118** are infrared-visible. In one example, the fiducial markers **118** are infrared reflective markers (e.g., the markers include infrared-reflective paint or stickers) that are configured to passively reflect infrared light emitted from the plurality of cameras **102** (or a separate active infrared light source). In another example, the fiducial markers **118** include active infrared illuminators (e.g., infrared LEDs) that are conspicuous to the IR or near-IR camera(s) **102**.

(31) In some examples, the fiducial markers **118** may be contained inside the measurement probe **114** and occluded from a human observer. Physical properties of the measurement probe **114** may allow for the unobstructed passage of IR light from the fiducial markers **118** through the

measurement probe **114** to the camera(s) **102**.

(32) In yet other examples, knowledge of the shape and appearance of the measurement probe **114** may be sufficient to serve the purpose of fiducial markers. For example, a planar surface, a right angle, or another geometric feature on the measurement probe **114** may be used as a fiducial marker.

(33) Note that in some examples the object under inspection **214** may also include fiducial markers that allow for the metrology information analysis application **210** to determine the position and orientation of the object under inspection **214**.

(34) The measurement probe **114** includes one or more metrology information sensors **300** that are configured to acquire metrology information **216** for the object under inspection **214**. The metrology information sensors **300** may include any suitable type and/or number of metrology sensors that are configured to acquire any suitable type of metrology information **216** for the object under inspection **214**. The metrology information **216** provides standard units of measurement that are used to describe physical characteristics of the object under inspection **214**. For example, the metrology information **216** for the object under inspection **214** can be acquired to assess a state or quality of the object under inspection **214**. In particular, the metrology information **216** for the object under inspection **214** can be compared to specified thresholds or requirements to determine whether conformity is achieved for different physical characteristics of the object under inspection **214**.

(35) In some embodiments, the measurement probe **114** includes an ultrasonic transducer **302** configured to acquire metrology information **216** in the form of subsurface information for the object under inspection **214**. For example, the subsurface information may be used to identify material defects, other types of degradation, or structure characteristics of various regions of the object under inspection **214**.

(36) In some embodiments, the measurement probe **114** includes a non-contact sensor **304** configured to acquire metrology information **216** in the form of electromagnetic radiation information for the object under inspection **214**. For example, the electromagnetic radiation information may be used to indicate radiation levels emitted by various regions of the object under inspection **214**.

(37) In some embodiments, the measurement probe **114** includes a force gauge **306** configured to acquire metrology information **216** in the form of force information for the object under inspection **214**. For example, the force information may be used to measure compression, tension, peel, or a coefficient of friction of various regions of the object under inspection **214**.

(38) In some embodiments, the metrology information **216** acquired by the measurement probe **114** can be used to determine a position of a local elastic modulus of a region of the object under inspection **214**. In some examples, the position of the local elastic modulus can be determined based on subsurface information acquired via an ultrasonic transducer of the measurement probe **114** and the position of the measurement probe **114** when the subsurface information is acquired. In other examples, the position of the local elastic modulus can be determined based on force information acquired via a force gauge of the measurement probe **114** and the position of the measurement probe **114** when the force information is acquired.

(39) In some embodiments, the measurement probe **114** includes a surface roughness sensor **308** configured to acquire metrology information **216** in the form of surface roughness information for the object under inspection **214**. In some embodiments, the measurement probe **114** includes a surface hardness sensor **310** configured to acquire metrology information **216** in the form of surface hardness information for the object under inspection **214**. In some embodiments, the measurement probe **114** includes a combination sensor that measures both surface hardness and surface roughness of a surface of the object under inspection **214**.

(40) Returning to FIG. 2, the metrology information analysis application **210** may be configured to determine the position and/or orientation of the object under inspection **214** and determine the

position and/or orientation of the measurement probe **114** based at least on the images **212** captured by the camera(s) **102** in any suitable manner. In one example, the metrology information analysis application **210** is configured to determine the position and orientation of the object under inspection **214** and the measurement probe **114** using direct linear transformation of positions of the fiducial markers **118** relative to one another. In some examples, determined positions of the object under inspection **214** and the measurement probe **114** may be defined in three degrees of freedom (e.g., X, Y, Z). In other examples, determined positions and orientations of the object under inspection **214** and the measurement probe **114** may be defined in six degrees of freedom (e.g., X, Y, Z, pitch, roll, yaw). Further, in the same manner, the metrology information analysis application **210** may be configured to track motion of the measurement probe **114** (and in some cases the object under inspection **214** if it moves) over time based on video (or a temporal sequence of images) captured by the camera(s) **102**.

(41) As discussed above, in some embodiments, the measurement probe **114** may be moved or controlled by a human inspector. In other embodiments, the measurement probe **114** may be moved or controlled via a robot. For example, the robot may move the measurement probe **114** through a movement routine (pre-programmed or dynamically specified) that allows for the measurement probe **114** to scan the object under inspection **214** to acquire metrology information.

(42) The metrology information analysis application **210** includes a graphical user interface (GUI) **218** that is displayed via the display **208**. The GUI **218** facilitates presentation of metrology information **216** acquired by the measurement probe **114** for the object under inspection **214**. In particular, the metrology information analysis application **210** is configured to spatially register the metrology information **216** acquired by the measurement probe **114** to one or more determined positions of the measurement probe **114** in the scene **104**. In one example, such spatial registration is embodied as a data structure, such as a vector that includes one or more metrology information values and spatial coordinate values corresponding to the position of the measurement probe **114** when the measurement probe **114** acquired the one or more metrology information values. Further, the metrology information analysis application **210** is configured to recognize when spatially registered metrology information values coincide with particular regions of the object under inspection **214** and associate the metrology information values with the particular regions of the object under inspection **214**.

(43) The metrology information analysis application **210** is configured to visually present, in the GUI **218**, a visual representation **220** of the metrology information spatially registered to determined positions of the measurement probe in the scene. The visual representation **220** of the metrology information spatially registered with the object under inspection **214** provides visual feedback to the inspector or another analyst. The visual representation **220** of the metrology information may take any suitable form.

(44) In some embodiments, the visual representation **220** of the metrology information is incorporated into one or more images of the object under inspection captured by the camera(s) **102**. FIG. 4 shows an example use case **400** in which the metrology information analysis application **210** generates and displays a visual representation of metrology information spatially registered to an object under inspection. In the illustrated example, the GUI **218** includes an image of the bicycle frame **112** (from FIG. 1) being inspected by the inspector **116**. The inspector **116** scans the bicycle frame **112** with the measurement probe **114**, which includes the ultrasonic transducer, to acquire subsurface information for the bicycle frame **112**. A visual representation **404** of the subsurface information is incorporated into the image **402**, such that the visual representation **404** of the subsurface information is spatially registered to a region of the bicycle frame **112** that is scanned by the measurement probe **114**. Note that only the portion of the bicycle frame **112** that has been scanned by the measurement probe **114** is augmented with spatially registered subsurface information, in this example.

(45) In the illustrated example, the subsurface information is visually represented using different

patterns to indicate different states of the material that make up the bicycle frame **112**. In particular, a region **406** of the bicycle frame **112** where a defect is present as informed by the subsurface information is visually distinguished by a different pattern than the surrounding material that is defect-free as informed by the subsurface information. In some examples, the visual representation **220** may take the form of a heat map indicating different levels of material thickness or other structural characteristics. In some examples, the subsurface information may be represented as a two-dimensional ultrasonic B-scan that shows a cross-sectional view of the inspected material depicting material thickness measured at different positions over time and spatially aligned with the bicycle frame **112** in the image **402**.

(46) The image **402** augmented with the visual representation **404** of the spatially registered subsurface information enables an inspector (or another analyst) to analyze the internal condition of the bicycle frame **112** in a quick and simple fashion without having to deal with the issues associated with traditional ultrasound inspection devices that have to be physically attached to an object and constantly adjusted for ultrasonic inspection.

(47) In some examples, the image **402** may be displayed in the GUI **218** as a “live” image or incorporated into a “live” video, that provides instant visual feedback to the inspector **116** as the inspector **116** is scanning the bicycle frame **112**. In other examples, the image **402** may be generated from a previous inspection event/session and displayed in the GUI **218** for review by an analyst after the scan of the bicycle frame **112** with the measurement probe **114** has been completed. Such “replay” functionality may allow for an ordinary inspector to perform the act of scanning an object under inspection to acquire metrology information for the object under inspection. Then, an expert analyst can review the image/video **402** augmented with the visual representation **404** of the spatially registered metrology information in order to perform analysis on the object under inspection **112** at their convenience.

(48) In some embodiments, the visual representation **220** of the metrology information includes a model of the object under inspection **214**. FIG. 5 shows an example use case **500** in which the metrology information analysis application **210** generates and displays a 3D model of the object under inspection textured with metrology information spatially registered to corresponding regions of the object under inspection. In the illustrated example, the GUI **218** includes a 3D model **502** of the bicycle frame **112** (from FIG. 1). The 3D model **502** is textured with subsurface information acquired by the ultrasonic transducer of the measurement probe **114**. The subsurface information is represented as different patterns corresponding to different structural states or characteristics of the material that make up the bicycle frame **112**. For example, the patterns representing the subsurface information may indicate various material thicknesses and may distinguish between degraded and non-degraded regions within the bicycle frame **112**. In some examples, the different patterns representing the subsurface information may have a high granularity of inspection by distinguishing the type of degradation, such as cracks, gaps, manufacturing flaws, and other forms of degradation. In one example, the subsurface information may be represented as an ultrasonic C-scan representing material thickness plotted over position both horizontally and vertically. The C-scan provides a visual map that reveals patterns of degradation as overall trends as well as at a granular point-level.

(49) In some examples, the 3D model **502** is manipulatable, such that a view of the 3D model **502** can be changed (e.g., rotated, zoomed in/out). Such manipulation of the 3D model may allow for an analyst to easily view subsurface information for any particular region of interest of the of the bicycle frame **112** even though the shape of the bicycle frame **112** has significant complexity.

(50) In some examples where the object under inspection includes movable parts, the metrology information analysis application **210** may be configured to create a kinematic 3D model of the object under inspection. Such a kinematic 3D model may represent various moving parts of an object under inspection with various movement constraints of the different parts. Further, the kinematic 3D model may include different subsurface information based on the different positions

of the moving parts. For example, a particular part may have different levels of stain when moved to one position relative to another position.

(51) In some embodiments, the visual representation **220** provides feedback that guides an inspector to accurately acquire metrology information **216** for the object under inspection **214**. FIG. **6** shows an example use case **600** in which the metrology information analysis application **210** generates and displays a visual representation **602** including a motion path **604** of the measurement probe **114** in the GUI **218**. The motion path **604** visually tracks motion of the measurement probe **114** over a designated time period. The designated time period may be specified in any suitable manner. In some examples, the designated time period is pre-determined. In some examples, the designated time period is user-specified. In some examples, the metrology information analysis application **210** is configured to toggle display of the motion path **604** on and off as desired by an inspector or analyst that is viewing the visual representation **602**.

(52) Additionally, the visual representation **602** includes metrology information **606** acquired by the measurement probe **114** at different points along the motion path **604**. The metrology information **606** is spatially registered to the position of the bicycle frame **112** as the measurement probe **114** scans the different regions of the bicycle frame **112**. The visual representation **602** indicates regions of the bicycle frame **112** that have been scanned by the measurement probe **114** and regions of the bicycle frame **112** that have not been scanned by the measurement probe **114**. In the illustrated example, the regions that have been scanned are distinguished by the metrology information **606** being spatially registered to the regions. On the other hand, the regions that have not been scanned show the un-augmented exterior/surface of the bicycle frame **112**. In different examples, the different regions may be distinguished from one another in any suitable manner. In some examples, the scanned and non-scanned regions may have different colors to help guide the inspector.

(53) In some examples, the visual representation **602** may include a video that is augmented with the motion path **604**. In some examples, the video can be paused at different time stamps to show the position of the measurement probe **114** at that time stamp and the corresponding ultrasound data generated at the time stamp. In some examples, the GUI **218** may be configured to toggle between different views including an actual view (non-augmented), a motion path view, and an ultrasound information view. In some examples, the different views may be overlaid on one another or composited together to form a hybrid view.

(54) Although these concepts have been described mostly within the context of ultrasonic analysis, the herein-described concepts are broadly applicable to any suitable form of metrology information acquisition for an object under inspection.

(55) Further, the system may take any suitable form. In some embodiments, the measurement probe, camera(s), and/or computer may be incorporated into a common device, such as a mobile device (e.g., hand-held device). In some examples, the system may include a head-mounted device including a display, camera(s), and/or computer. In some examples, the measurement probe may be wired or wirelessly connected to the head-mounted device. In some examples, the computer may include a remote computing system (e.g., a cloud computing system).

(56) FIG. **7** is a flow chart of an example computer-implemented freeform metrology acquisition method **700**. For example, the computer-implemented method **700** may be performed by the computing device **110** shown in FIGS. **1** and **2** or another computing device.

(57) At **702**, the computer-implemented method **700** includes receiving, from a measurement probe, metrology information for an object under inspection acquired by the measurement probe.

(58) At **704**, the computer-implemented method **700** includes receiving, from one or more cameras, one or more images of a scene including the measurement probe and the object under inspection;

(59) At **706**, the computer-implemented method **700** includes determining a position of the measurement probe in the scene based at least on the one or more images;

(60) At **708**, the computer-implemented method **700** includes spatially registering the metrology

information acquired by the measurement probe to one or more determined positions of the measurement probe in the scene; and

(61) At **710**, the computer-implemented method **700** includes visually presenting, via a display, a visual representation of the metrology information spatially registered to the one or more determined positions of the measurement probe in the scene. In some embodiments, at **712**, the visual representation of the metrology information optionally may be incorporated into one or more images of the object under inspection captured by the one or more cameras. In some embodiments, at **714**, a 3D model of the object under inspection textured with metrology information spatially registered to corresponding regions of the object under inspection. In some embodiments, at **716**, the visual representation may include a motion path of the measurement probe in the scene and corresponding metrology information acquired by the measurement probe at different points along the motion path. In some embodiments, at **718**, the visual representation may indicate regions of the object under inspection that have been scanned by the measurement probe and regions of the object under inspection that have not been scanned by the measurement probe.

(62) The visual representation of the spatially register metrology information provides visual feedback that enables an inspector to accurately acquire metrology information for an object under inspection in a freeform manner. Moreover, the visual representation of the spatially register metrology information allows for an inspector or analyst to gain a deeper understanding of state of the underlying structure of the object being inspected in a quick and easily consumable manner.

(63) In some embodiments, the methods and processes described herein may be tied to a computing system of one or more computing devices. In particular, such methods and processes may be implemented as a computer-application program or service, an application-programming interface (API), a library, and/or other computer-program product.

(64) FIG. **8** schematically shows a non-limiting embodiment of a computing system **800** that can enact one or more of the methods and processes described above. Computing system **800** is shown in simplified form. Computing system **800** may embody the computing device **110** described above and illustrated in FIGS. **1** and **2**. Computing system **800** may take the form of one or more personal computers, server computers, tablet computers, network computing devices, mobile computing devices, mobile communication devices (e.g., smart phone), wearable computing devices such as smart wristwatches and head mounted augmented reality devices, and/or other computing devices.

(65) Computing system **800** includes a logic processor **802**, volatile memory **804**, and a non-volatile storage device **806**. Computing system **800** may optionally include a display subsystem **808**, input subsystem **810**, communication subsystem **812**, and/or other components not shown in FIG. **1**.

(66) Logic processor **802** includes one or more physical devices configured to execute instructions. For example, the logic processor may be configured to execute instructions that are part of one or more applications, programs, routines, libraries, objects, components, data structures, or other logical constructs. Such instructions may be implemented to perform a task, implement a data type, transform the state of one or more components, achieve a technical effect, or otherwise arrive at a desired result.

(67) The logic processor may include one or more physical processors (hardware) configured to execute software instructions. Additionally or alternatively, the logic processor may include one or more hardware logic circuits or firmware devices configured to execute hardware-implemented logic or firmware instructions. Processors of the logic processor **802** may be single-core or multi-core, and the instructions executed thereon may be configured for sequential, parallel, and/or distributed processing. Individual components of the logic processor optionally may be distributed among two or more separate devices, which may be remotely located and/or configured for coordinated processing. Aspects of the logic processor may be virtualized and executed by remotely accessible, networked computing devices configured in a cloud-computing configuration. In such a case, these virtualized aspects are run on different physical logic processors of various

different machines, it will be understood.

(68) Non-volatile storage device **806** includes one or more physical devices configured to hold instructions executable by the logic processors to implement the methods and processes described herein. When such methods and processes are implemented, the state of non-volatile storage device **806** may be transformed—e.g., to hold different data.

(69) Non-volatile storage device **806** may include physical devices that are removable and/or built-in. Non-volatile storage device **806** may include optical memory (e.g., CD, DVD, HD-DVD, Blu-Ray Disc, etc.), semiconductor memory (e.g., ROM, EPROM, EEPROM, FLASH memory, etc.), and/or magnetic memory (e.g., hard-disk drive, floppy-disk drive, tape drive, MRAM, etc.), or other mass storage device technology. Non-volatile storage device **806** may include nonvolatile, dynamic, static, read/write, read-only, sequential-access, location-addressable, file-addressable, and/or content-addressable devices. It will be appreciated that non-volatile storage device **806** is configured to hold instructions even when power is cut to the non-volatile storage device **806**.

(70) Volatile memory **804** may include physical devices that include random access memory. Volatile memory **804** is typically utilized by logic processor **802** to temporarily store information during processing of software instructions. It will be appreciated that volatile memory **804** typically does not continue to store instructions when power is cut to the volatile memory **804**.

(71) Aspects of logic processor **802**, volatile memory **804**, and non-volatile storage device **806** may be integrated together into one or more hardware-logic components. Such hardware-logic components may include field-programmable gate arrays (FPGAs), program- and application-specific integrated circuits (ASIC/ASICs), program- and application-specific standard products (PSSP/ASSPs), system-on-a-chip (SOC), and complex programmable logic devices (CPLDs), for example.

(72) The terms “module,” “program,” and “engine” may be used to describe an aspect of computing system **800** typically implemented in software by a processor to perform a particular function using portions of volatile memory, which function involves transformative processing that specially configures the processor to perform the function. Thus, a module, program, or engine may be instantiated via logic processor **802** executing instructions held by non-volatile storage device **806**, using portions of volatile memory **804**. It will be understood that different modules, programs, and/or engines may be instantiated from the same application, service, code block, object, library, routine, API, function, etc. Likewise, the same module, program, and/or engine may be instantiated by different applications, services, code blocks, objects, routines, APIs, functions, etc. The terms “module,” “program,” and “engine” may encompass individual or groups of executable files, data files, libraries, drivers, scripts, database records, etc.

(73) When included, display subsystem **808** may be used to present a visual representation of data held by non-volatile storage device **806**. The visual representation may take the form of a graphical user interface (GUI). As the herein described methods and processes change the data held by the non-volatile storage device, and thus transform the state of the non-volatile storage device, the state of display subsystem **808** may likewise be transformed to visually represent changes in the underlying data. Display subsystem **808** may include one or more display devices utilizing virtually any type of technology. Such display devices may be combined with logic processor **802**, volatile memory **804**, and/or non-volatile storage device **806** in a shared enclosure, or such display devices may be peripheral display devices.

(74) When included, input subsystem **810** may comprise or interface with one or more user-input devices such as a keyboard, mouse, touch screen, or game controller. In some embodiments, the input subsystem may comprise or interface with selected natural user input (NUI) componentry. Such componentry may be integrated or peripheral, and the transduction and/or processing of input actions may be handled on- or off-board. Example NUI componentry may include a microphone for speech and/or voice recognition; an infrared, color, stereoscopic, and/or depth camera for machine vision and/or gesture recognition; a head tracker, eye tracker, accelerometer, and/or

gyroscope for motion detection and/or intent recognition; as well as electric-field sensing componentry for assessing brain activity; and/or any other suitable sensor.

(75) When included, communication subsystem **812** may be configured to communicatively couple various computing devices described herein with each other, and with other devices.

Communication subsystem **812** may include wired and/or wireless communication devices compatible with one or more different communication protocols. As non-limiting examples, the communication subsystem may be configured for communication via a wireless telephone network, or a wired or wireless local- or wide-area network, such as a HDMI over Wi-Fi connection. In some embodiments, the communication subsystem may allow computing system **800** to send and/or receive messages to and/or from other devices via a network such as the Internet.

(76) The subject matter of the present disclosure includes all novel and non-obvious combinations and sub-combinations of the various processes, systems and configurations, and other features, functions, acts, and/or properties disclosed herein, as well as any and all equivalents thereof.

Claims

1. A freeform metrology information acquisition system, the system comprising: a measurement probe configured to obtain metrology information for an object under inspection; one or more cameras configured to image a scene including the measurement probe and the object under inspection; and a computing device communicatively coupled to the measurement probe and the one or more cameras, the computing device comprising: one or more processors configured to execute instructions stored in memory to: receive the metrology information from the measurement probe; receive from the one or more cameras a sequence of images of the scene including the measurement probe and the object under inspection; track a position of the measurement probe in the scene based at least on the sequence of images; spatially register the metrology information acquired by the measurement probe to tracked positions of the measurement probe in the scene; track a position of the object in the scene based at least on the sequence of images; and visually present, via a display, a visual representation of the object under inspection textured with a visual representation of at least some of the metrology information that has a tracked position in spatial alignment with the tracked position of the object under inspection.
2. The system of claim 1, wherein the visual representation of the object under inspection includes one or more images of the sequence of images, and wherein the visual representation of the at least some of the metrology information is incorporated into the one or more images.
3. The system of claim 1, wherein the one or more processors are configured to execute instructions stored in the memory to: visually present, via the display, a motion path of the measurement probe in the scene and corresponding metrology information acquired by the measurement probe at different points along the motion path.
4. The system of claim 1, wherein the visual representation of the object under inspection includes a three-dimensional (3D) model of the object under inspection.
5. The system of claim 1, wherein the visual representation of the object under inspection indicates regions of the object under inspection that have been scanned by the measurement probe and regions of the object under inspection that have not been scanned by the measurement probe.
6. The system of claim 1, wherein the measurement probe includes a plurality of markers having positions fixed relative to one another, and wherein the computing device is configured to determine the position of the measurement probe in the scene based at least on the positions of the plurality of markers in the sequence of images.
7. The system of claim 1, wherein the measurement probe includes an ultrasonic transducer, and wherein the metrology information includes subsurface information acquired by the ultrasonic transducer for the object under inspection.
8. The system of claim 1, wherein the measurement probe includes a non-contact sensor, and

wherein the metrology information includes electromagnetic radiation information acquired by the non-contact sensor for the object under inspection.

9. The system of claim 1, wherein the measurement probe includes a force gauge, and wherein the metrology information includes force information acquired by the force gauge for the object under inspection.

10. The system of claim 1, wherein the computing device is configured to determine a position of a local elastic modulus of a region of the object under inspection based on the metrology information acquired by the measurement probe and a determined position of the measurement probe.

11. A computer-implemented freeform metrology information acquisition method, the method comprising: receiving, from a measurement probe, metrology information for an object under inspection acquired by the measurement probe; receiving, from one or more cameras, a sequence of images of a scene including the measurement probe and the object under inspection; tracking a position of the measurement probe in the scene based at least on the sequence of images; spatially registering the metrology information acquired by the measurement probe to tracked positions of the measurement probe in the scene; tracking a position of the object in the scene based at least on the sequence of images; and visually presenting, via a display, a visual representation of the object under inspection textured with a visual representation of at least some of the metrology information that has a tracked position in spatial alignment with the tracked position of the object under inspection.

12. The method of claim 11, wherein the visual representation of the object under inspection includes one or more images of the sequence of images, and wherein the visual representation of the at least some of the metrology information is incorporated into the one or more images.

13. The method of claim 11, further comprising: visually presenting, via the display, a motion path of the measurement probe in the scene and corresponding metrology information acquired by the measurement probe at different points along the motion path.

14. The method of claim 11, wherein the visual representation of the object under inspection includes a 3D model of the object under inspection.

15. The method of claim 11, wherein the visual representation of the object under inspection indicates regions of the object under inspection that have been scanned by the measurement probe and regions of the object under inspection that have not been scanned by the measurement probe.

16. The method of claim 11, wherein the measurement probe includes a plurality of markers having positions fixed relative to one another, and wherein the method further comprises determining the position of the measurement probe in the scene based at least on the positions of the plurality of markers in the sequence of images.

17. The method of claim 11, wherein the measurement probe includes an ultrasonic transducer, and wherein the metrology information includes subsurface information acquired by the ultrasonic transducer for the object under inspection.

18. The method of claim 11, wherein the measurement probe includes a non-contact sensor, and wherein the metrology information includes electromagnetic radiation information acquired by the non-contact sensor for the object under inspection.

19. The method of claim 11, wherein the measurement probe includes a force gauge, and wherein the metrology information includes force information acquired by the force gauge for the object under inspection.

20. A computing device comprising: one or more processors configured to execute instructions stored in memory to: receive from a measurement probe metrology information for an object under inspection acquired by the measurement probe; receive from one or more cameras a sequence of images of a scene including the measurement probe and the object under inspection; track a position of the measurement probe in the scene based at least on the sequence of images; spatially register the metrology information acquired by the measurement probe to tracked positions of the measurement probe in the scene; track a position of the object in the scene based at least on the

sequence of images; and visually present, via a display, a visual representation of the object under inspection textured with a visual representation of at least some of the metrology information that has a tracked position in spatial alignment with the tracked position of the object under inspection.
